



Multi Factor Authentication (MFA)

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What is Multi Factor Authentication (MFA)?

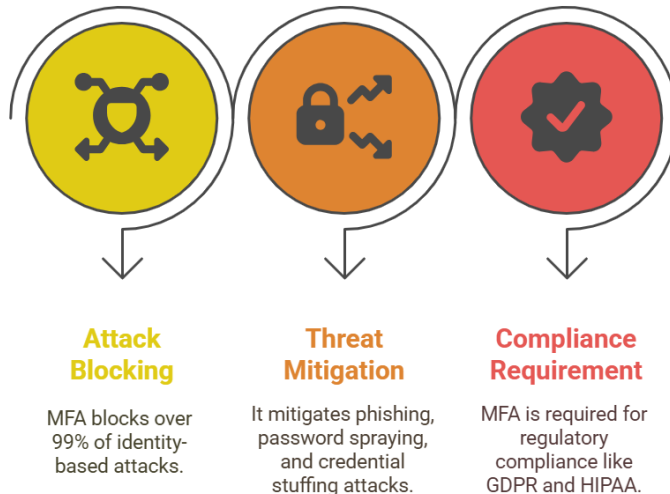
- MFA requires two or more verification factors to access an account.
- Factors include:
 - Something you know (password)
 - Something you have (phone, security key)
 - Something you are (biometrics)

Reduces the risk of unauthorized access even if a password is compromised.



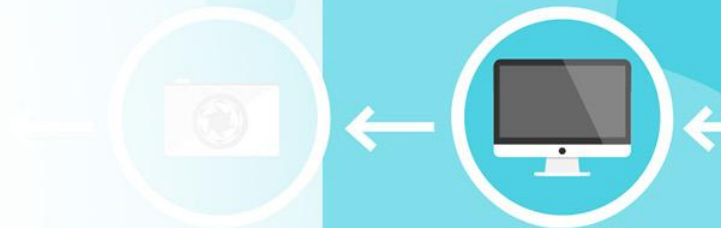
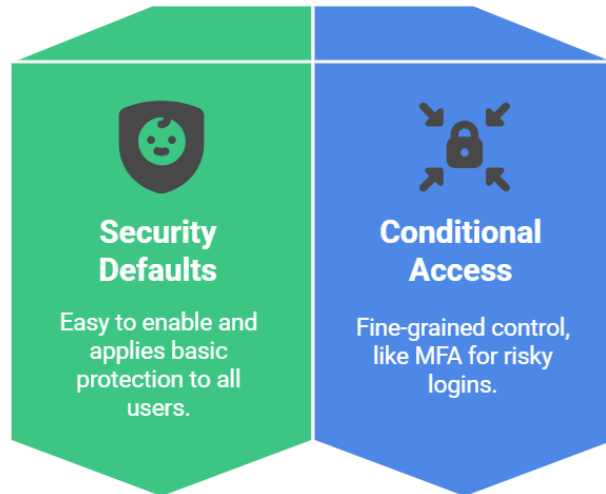
Why MFA is Critical?

- Over 99% of identity-based attacks can be blocked with MFA.
- Common threats it mitigates:
 - Phishing – tricking users into revealing credentials through fake websites or emails.
 - Password Spraying – trying common passwords across many accounts.
 - Credential Stuffing – using stolen username/password pairs from other breaches.
- Required for compliance (e.g., GDPR, HIPAA, NIST).



How MFA Works in Entra ID / Azure / Microsoft 365

- Integrated with Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure AD).
- Applies to Microsoft 365 services: Outlook, Teams, OneDrive, etc.
- How to deploy:
 - **Security Defaults:** Easy to enable, applies basic protection to all users.
 - **Conditional Access Policies:** Fine-grained control (e.g., require MFA for high-risk logins or external locations).
 - Supports Risk Based Adaptive MFA: Uses real-time risk detection to challenge users only when necessary



MFA Methods Supported by Microsoft

- Microsoft Authenticator App – Approve a push notification or enter a code from the app.
- SMS or Phone Call – Receive a text message or voice call with a code.
- FIDO2 Security Keys – Use a physical USB or NFC device for secure login.
- Windows Hello for Business – Biometric or PIN-based login tied to the device.
- Temporary Access Pass (TAP) – Time-limited passcode used for initial sign-in or recovery.





What Licenses Do You Need?

Feature	License Required	Notes
Security Defaults	Free (Entra ID Free / Microsoft 365)	Tenant-wide enforcement with limited customization. Authenticator app required.
Conditional Access MFA	Entra ID P1 (or included in M365 E3/E5)	Enables targeted MFA enforcement using conditions like user risk, location, or app.
Risk-based / Adaptive MFA	Entra ID P2 (or included in M365 E5)	Uses real-time risk detection to challenge users only when necessary.